

Unequal access by design

Industrial zoning and spatial justice in
Seattle's Lower Duwamish corridor

Yijun Zhang

MKSK

Research diagnosis + FOOD. CO. studio proposal



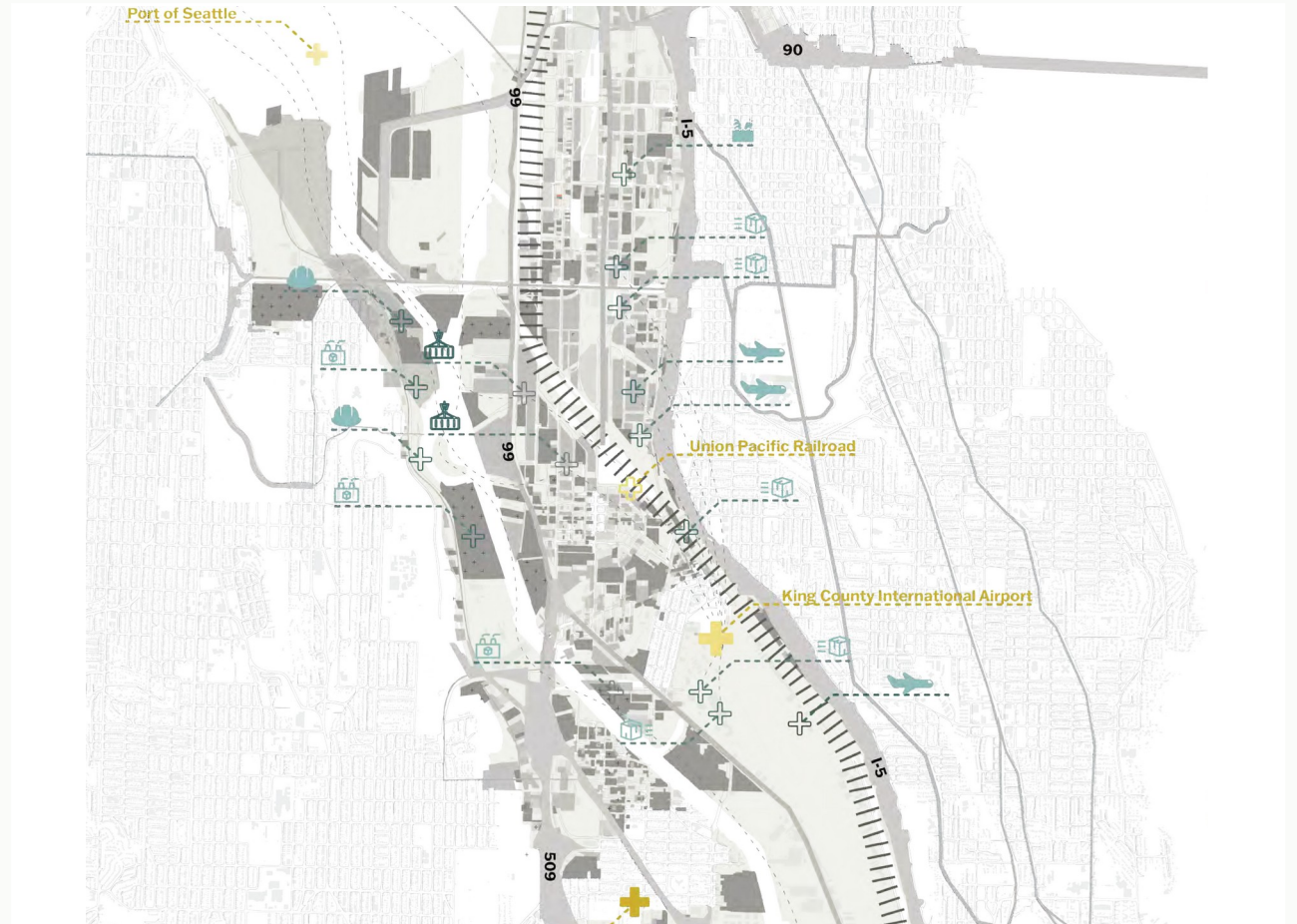
FOOD. CO. · Studio design scenario

Industry and everyday life share a corridor

Georgetown + South Park

Residential life alongside
manufacturing, maritime activity
and logistics

How do land-use decisions
shape everyday access?



Read access through patterns and experience

Connect mapped patterns with community perspectives

01

Spatial patterns

GIS + municipal data

Zoning

Public + environmental access

02

Social conditions

American Community Survey

Household income

Socioeconomic context

03

Community input

Team–community workshop

Everyday mobility

Public space + participation

Approximate study period: 2023–2025

Exact dataset vintages, access measures and workshop details are not supplied.

Industrial land dominates both neighborhoods

Land designated for maritime manufacturing and logistics



A strong spatial concentration; the bars do not establish causation.

Approximate period: 2023–2025. Exact zoning vintage, boundaries and calculation are not supplied.

Access constraints extend beyond zoning

Spatial concentration corresponds with several access constraints

PUBLIC SPACE

Limited public green space and environmental amenities

MOBILITY

Fragmented mobility networks

HOUSEHOLD RESOURCES

Median incomes below the King County average

Community perspectives describe persistent, structural constraints.

FOOD. CO.: a studio response to access

Community

Spaces for everyday use

Containers

Adapt existing logistics assets

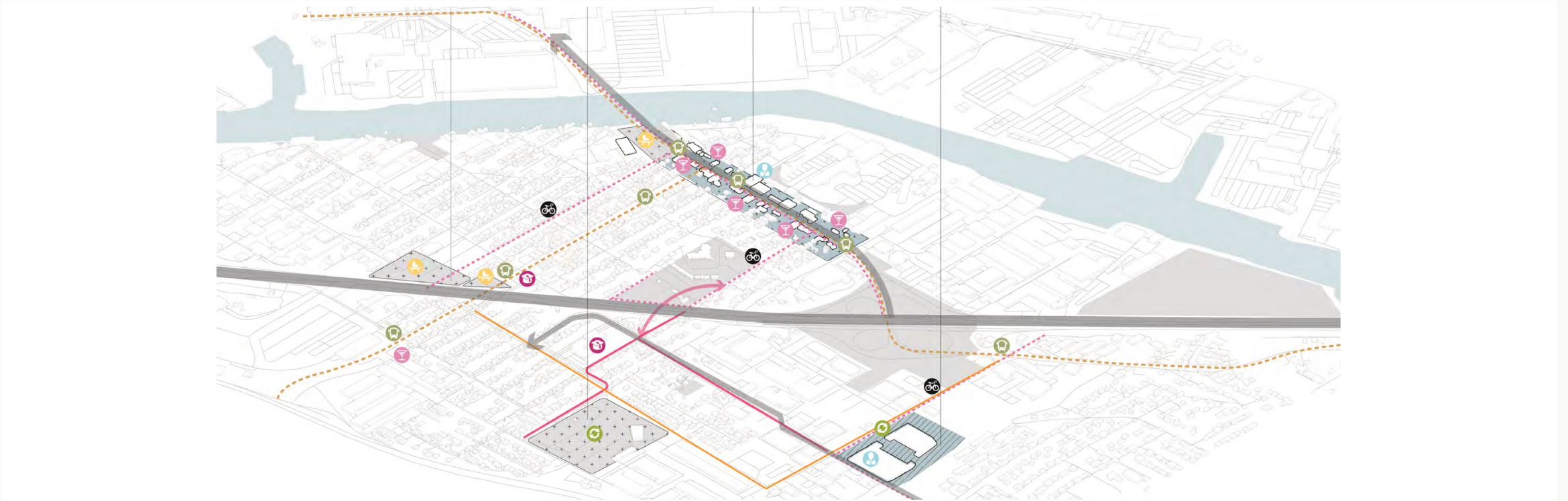
Collaboration

Link organizations and services



Proposed public-space functions; no measured implementation outcomes.

Connect four sites through shared services



South Park

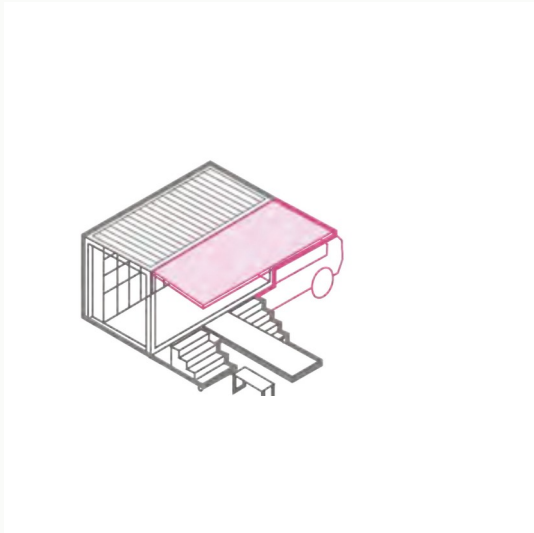
Marra Farm

**Duwamish River
Community Hub**

Food Lifeline

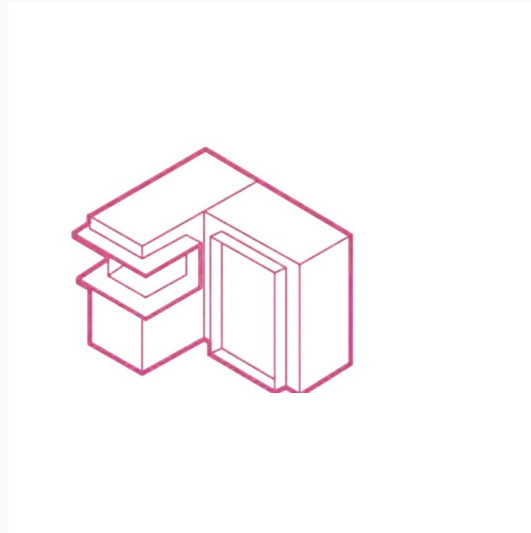
Adapt containers to different access needs

One design vocabulary, several community functions



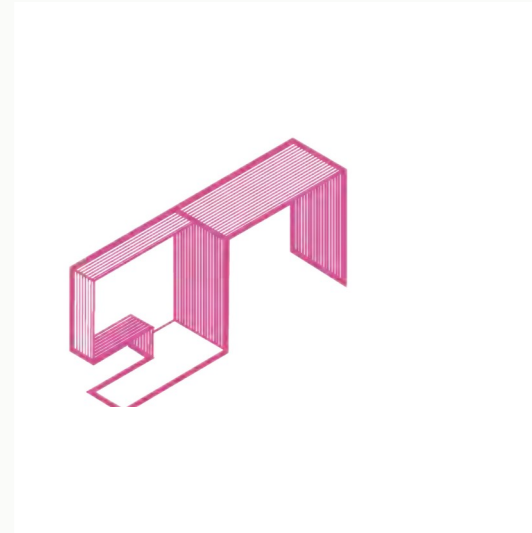
Café bus

Food service



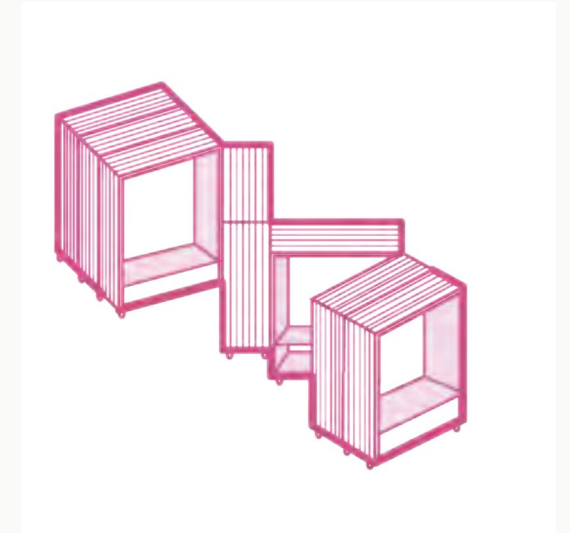
Collection module

Food-waste collection



Bus stop

Transit waiting



Seating

Shared space

Make Food Lifeline's edge a public interface



1 Entry plaza

Events + café

2 Pedestrian edge

Movement + urban farm

3 Loading areas

Retain operational functions

Operational compatibility and safe circulation need testing.

Bring mobility and food-waste collection together

Coordinate movement, collection and places to wait



Collection

Food-waste collection points

Transit

Bio-bus concept + stops

Cycling

Bike racks + pavilions

Plan for access, then test the proposal

Make everyday access an explicit concern in industrial land-use decisions.

NEXT VALIDATION

Verify baselines

Zoning, access measures and dataset vintages

Develop together

Residents, site organizations and transport operators

Test operation

Usefulness, safety, costs, maintenance and governance

References

RESEARCH ABSTRACT

Author and date not stated. Unequal Access by Design: Industrial Zoning and Spatial Justice in Seattle's Lower Duwamish Corridor.

Presenter-supplied conference abstract · ACSP.pdf, p. 1

STUDIO PROJECT + VISUALS

Li, Su; Zhang, Yijun; Zheng, Yanrong. n.d. FOOD. CO. LARCH 507 studio project, led by Catherine de Almeida.

Presenter-supplied portfolio · LARC507_SL_YZ_YZ.PDF.pdf, PDF pp. 1–12

Presenter clarification: Yijun Zhang, MKSK; approximate 2023–2025 period; team–community workshop.